

Free Beginner Knitting Pattern

Your First Project: Simple Dishcloth

A Complete Guide for Absolute Beginners

 Download this guide and start your knitting journey today!

What's Inside

1. Welcome to Knitting
2. Supplies You'll Need
3. Basic Techniques
4. Your First Pattern: Dishcloth
5. Troubleshooting Guide
6. Your Next Steps

Welcome to Knitting

Congratulations on deciding to learn knitting! You're about to start a rewarding hobby that millions of people around the world love.

Why You'll Love Knitting

- **Meditative:** Knitting is calming. Your hands stay busy while your mind relaxes.
- **Creative:** You make beautiful things. Scarves, hats, blankets—all from your own hands.
- **Affordable:** Start with just \$5-15 in supplies. Everything else is free.
- **Flexible:** Do it anywhere. While watching TV, on the bus, in the park.
- **Social:** Join communities of knitters. Share projects. Get support.

Good news: This guide assumes you've never knitted before. Every step is explained clearly. You'll be making your first project in 1-2 hours.

Supplies You'll Need

Here's exactly what to buy for your first project:

1. Needles

Size: US 8-10 (5-6mm needles)

Type: Straight needles (the basic kind)

Material: Bamboo or metal (bamboo won't let yarn slip)

Cost: \$2-4 at any craft store

Where: Michaels, Joann, Walmart, Amazon, or local craft store

2. Yarn

Weight: Worsted weight (also called "medium" or "4-ply")

Fiber: 100% acrylic (cheap, easy to knit, machine washable)

Color: Light color (easier to see your stitches)

Amount: You need 200-300 yards

Cost: \$3-5

Example: Red Heart "Super Saver" - commonly available everywhere

3. Stitch Markers (Optional but Helpful)

Cost: \$2-3 for a set of 10

Alternative: Use safety pins or even yarn in a different color

Total Cost: \$7-12

That's it! You can get all of this at a single craft store in 15 minutes.



Pro Tip: Buy acrylic yarn for your first project. It's forgiving, easy to knit, and cheap if you make mistakes.

Basic Techniques

1. How to Hold Your Needles

There are two main ways:

- **Pencil grip:** Hold needles like you're writing (most common for beginners)
- **Knife grip:** Hold top needle like a knife. This is faster but takes practice.

For now, use pencil grip. It's easier to control.

2. Casting On

What it is: How you put the initial loops of yarn onto your needle.

For this pattern: We'll use the "Long Tail Cast On" (most popular for beginners)

Steps:

1. Make a loop with your yarn about 1.5 feet from the end
2. Slip needle through the loop
3. Pull yarn to tighten
4. Repeat until you have 25 stitches

Don't worry if your cast-on looks messy. It gets better with practice. What matters is that you have loops on the needle.

3. The Knit Stitch

This is the most basic stitch. Once you master this, you can make almost anything.

Steps:

1. Hold needle with loops in left hand
2. Insert right needle through first loop (front to back)
3. Wrap yarn around right needle
4. Pull yarn through to create new loop
5. Drop old loop off left needle
6. Repeat for all stitches

First row will feel awkward. This is normal. By row 10, muscle memory kicks in and it becomes automatic.

4. Binding Off

What it is: How you finish your project so stitches don't unravel.

Steps:

1. Knit two stitches
2. Slip first stitch over second stitch
3. Knit one more stitch
4. Repeat until one stitch remains
5. Cut yarn and pull through final stitch

Your First Pattern: Simple Dishcloth

Pattern Difficulty: Beginner

Time to Complete: 1-2 hours

Finished Size: About 8" x 8"

Materials

- US 8-10 needles (5-6mm)
- Worsted weight yarn, light color, 200-300 yards

Pattern

Cast on: 20 stitches using long tail cast on

Row 1: Knit every stitch

Row 2: Knit every stitch

Row 3: Knit every stitch

Row 4: Knit every stitch

Repeat Rows 1-4 until your piece is square (or until you run low on yarn)

Bind off all stitches (see instructions above)

Weave in ends - trim loose yarn threads

What You're Creating

You're making a **garter stitch** dishcloth. Garter stitch is:

- The easiest stitch to knit
- Thick and absorbent (perfect for washing dishes)
- Looks the same on both sides

Counting Rows



To know when your square is square, count your rows. It should roughly equal the number of stitches across (20 rows for 20 stitches).

Troubleshooting Common Mistakes

Problem: Yarn keeps falling off my needle

Cause: Stitches aren't tight enough

Solution: Pull yarn tighter after each stitch. It'll feel too tight at first, but loosen as you gain control.

Problem: My knitting looks uneven

Cause: Tension is inconsistent. This is 100% normal for beginners.

Solution: Keep practicing. After 50 stitches, you'll notice it evens out. After 100, it'll look much better.

Problem: I dropped a stitch

Solution for small gaps: Don't panic. Use a smaller needle (or crochet hook) to pick up the dropped stitch and pull it back through the loop.

Solution if too far back: Unravel back to that point and reknit. Sounds scary, but it's easier than it sounds.

Problem: My first row looks sloppy

This is completely normal. Cast-on rows are always messy-looking. By row 5, you won't even notice it.

Problem: I think I need to restart



Don't quit! Mistakes are learning. Keep going. It gets easier, I promise.

Your Next Steps

After Your Dishcloth

Congratulations! You just completed your first knitting project. You should be proud—you made something real with your own hands.

What to do with your dishcloth: Use it! It's actually functional. Put it in your kitchen. Let it remind you that you can make things.

What's Next?

You have three paths:

Path 1: Keep Practicing (Free)

Make more dishcloths. Practice your tension. Get comfortable with the knit stitch. This takes a few more hours but costs nothing.

Path 2: Beginner Bundle (\$19)

Move to the next level with 3 new patterns (scarf, hat, baby blanket). Includes video guides so you see exactly how to do each stitch. Most popular option.

Path 3: Dive Deep with Starter Pack (\$39)

Jump straight to 5 patterns + full video course + community. For people who want to learn fast and get support.

My Recommendation

If you loved making your dishcloth, get the Beginner Bundle. At \$19, it's incredibly affordable, and the 3 patterns will keep you engaged and progressing for weeks.

Questions?

Email me anytime: support@abstractemporium.com

Or visit our community and ask other knitters for help.

Happy Knitting! 🧶

— The Abstract Emporium Team

Helpful Resources

Knitting Websites & Communities

- **Ravelry.com** - The world's largest knitting community. Track projects, find patterns, and connect with millions of knitters.
- **PurlSoho.com** - Professional knitting tutorials, free patterns, and expert tips from industry leaders.
- **VeryPinkKnits.com** - Clear, beginner-friendly tutorials with video demonstrations.
- **Craftsy.com** - Comprehensive knitting classes ranging from absolute beginner to advanced.
- **AllFreeKnitting.com** - Free patterns, tutorials, and project inspiration.

YouTube Channels for Beginners

- **VeryPink Knits** - Slow-paced tutorials perfect for visual learners (YouTube: @verrypinkknits)
- **Nimble Needles** - Clear, step-by-step instruction with excellent camera angles (YouTube: @nimbleneedles)
- **Sheep & Stitch** - Friendly, encouraging knitting tutorials (YouTube: @sheepandstitch)
- **Wool and the Gang** - Trendy patterns with clear video guides (YouTube: @woolandthegang)

Essential Tools & Supplies

- **LoveCrafts.com** - Largest online yarn store with competitive prices
- **KnitPicks.com** - High-quality needles and yarn at affordable prices
- **WEBS.com** - Wide selection and helpful staff expertise

- **LocalYarnShops.com** - Directory to find knitting shops in your area (support local!)

💡 **Pro Tip:** Join local knitting groups or guilds in your area for in-person support and friendships with fellow knitters!

Stay Connected

Email: abstractemporiumart@outlook.com

Facebook - Art & Community: facebook.com/abstractemporium

Facebook - Knitting: facebook.com/LissaKnittingCreations

Instagram: instagram.com/Abstractemporiumart

X/Twitter: x.com/Abstractempco23

Next Step: Ready for more patterns? Check out our Beginner Bundle (\$19) for 3 complete patterns + video guides!